Such policy matters can well be presented before the organisations like the Rotary Club, Lions Club, Junior Chamber, Bombay's Progressive group or before intellectual class of lawyers, graduates, professors, college students and businessmen … the first general secretary of Bharatiya Jana Sangh Prof. Dr. Bhai Mahavir defended such speakers … and bravely declared that these are the planks and fundamentals of Jana Sangh and no Bharatiya Jana Sangh leader can afford to bypass such matters … True, we also agree. But before whom all these policy matters are to be placed? Before the hungry, roofless and half-naked masses? Definitely not …

May I humbly submit to Dr. Bhai Mahavir that for the Communist Party, the recognition of East Germany, North Korea, North Vietnam is the fundamental plank of the party, but they never emphasise these matters before the masses, working class and proletariat.

Jan Sangh leaders realised that they were top-heavy and a party of intellectuals (albeit of the opposite kind vis-à-vis the prevailing Left/liberal mindset), and they did not have enough feet on the ground. They began to focus on creating a cadre using strategies employed by the RSS. 'We were told day in and day out that workers cannot be created through public meetings or newspapers. But we now find that the RSS now a days hold big public meetings and runs a chain of newspapers throughout the country.' The idea was to create empowered local groups of leaders with the autonomy to act within the party's basic ideology. Here, the Sangh looked up to leaders like D.B. Thengde of the Bharatiya Mazoor Sangh, who would tell his workers, 'You are allowed to make a mistake, but with one condition, that is you should not repeat the same kind of mistake. I shall allow you to commit another kind of mistake.'[115]

After the Jan Sangh joined governments for the first time in 1967, Mehta argued they did not leverage their election gains for power-sharing. Unlike the aggressive BJP of Maharashtra 2019, which refused to compromise with the Shiv Sena, the Jan Sangh, despite being in power in UP, Bihar, Punjab and MP in 1967, did not ask for big portfolios. It had ninety-nine of 215 government MLAs in UP, but did not get powerful portfolios like Home, Finance or Labour. 'As against this we find that with 43 MLAs the Communist Party